AI for Fantasy Baseball

Practical tips from AI Office Hours · First Pitch Arizona 2026

Nick Richards · Facts checked October 2026. Menus, plans, and prices change often, so confirm on the provider's own page before you rely on one.

These tips work with any AI assistant. I use and recommend Claude, but the examples cover ChatGPT and Gemini too. Pick the tool you like; the habits matter more than the brand.

1 Choose your tier

- **If you can afford it, pay for the roughly $20/month tier.** You get what you pay for: the paid tier is a better experience, and the free tiers no longer get each company's strongest model.
- **What the $20 tier buys today:**
  - **Claude Pro**: $20/month ($17/month billed annually). Free includes the Sonnet and Haiku models; Pro adds Opus and at least 5x the usage per session.
  - **ChatGPT Plus**: $20/month. Adds the stronger "Thinking" reasoning model, which the free plan doesn't get.
  - **Google AI Pro**: $19.99/month. Since October 9, free Gemini users are limited to the lightweight Flash-Lite model.
- **Watch the names.** At Claude and Google, "Pro" is the ~$20 plan. At ChatGPT, the ~$20 plan is *Plus*, and "Pro" is a much pricier heavy-use tier.
- **Paying buys a stronger model, not a truthful one.** Every tip below still applies.

2 One-time setup

- **Write account-wide instructions first.** It's the highest-payoff five minutes you'll spend. They apply to every chat, so you stop repeating yourself.

Tool	Where to set them
Claude	Settings → Account → **Instructions for Claude** (Mac app; the web and phone apps may place it differently)
ChatGPT	Web/desktop: Settings → Personalization → **Custom Instructions**. Phone: Settings → Customize ChatGPT
Gemini	gemini.google.com → Explore Gems → **New Gem** (a Gem is a saved set of instructions you open for a task)

- **Keep them short.** ChatGPT's Free and Go plans cap custom instructions at 1,500 characters (5,000 on Plus and up). The template in section 3 fits with room to spare.
- **One project per job.** A project bundles instructions, files, and chats for one task: one per league, one for draft prep, one for trades. Claude's free plan allows up to five projects. ChatGPT also has Projects; in Gemini, make a Gem per job.
- **Put your league's actual rules in the project.** Scoring, roster slots, keeper rules, FAAB. Without them, the AI tends to assume a standard 5x5 roto league.

- **Check what it remembers.** Claude has a Memory page in Settings. Open it now and then, and correct or delete anything wrong. If your tool keeps memories, do the same.
- **Make your privacy choice.** On Claude's individual plans, training on your chats is opt-out, so if you'd rather it didn't, turn it off under Settings → Privacy. Check the equivalent setting in any other tool.

3 Templates to copy

ACCOUNT-WIDE INSTRUCTIONS · 599 characters

I play fantasy baseball and use AI for research and decisions.
- Never guess. If you aren't sure, say so. Don't invent stats, quotes, or sources. If you can't cite it, say that.
- When you give a number, tell me where it came from and how current it is.
- If something could have changed recently (injuries, roles, transactions), look it up or flag it.
- Push back when I'm wrong. Don't flatter me.
- If my question is missing something you need, ask before answering.
- Show your math, or put it in a spreadsheet.
- Write like I talk: [plain / casual / blunt]. Keep it short unless I ask for depth.

LEAGUE PROJECT INSTRUCTIONS · fill in the brackets

League: [name], [12]-team [H2H points / roto], [dynasty / redraft]. The rules are in the attached file; use them for every valuation.
Projections: use only the attached BaseballHQ export dated [date]. If a player isn't in it, say so. Don't fill in from memory.
My roster is in roster.csv.
On trades, value both sides and tell me what the other owner gains.

4 Using BaseballHQ tools with AI

- **The AI doesn't have HQ's projections. You bring them.** Run the Custom Draft Guide (or whichever HQ output you use), save it, upload it to your league project, and tell the AI that file is the authority.
- **Make it compute from the file, not from memory.** Ask for a spreadsheet with formulas instead of arithmetic in prose. Good jobs for it: merging the CDG's separate hitter and pitcher lists into one, converting values to your league's points scoring, sorting by position or by team need.
- **Date-stamp every upload**, e.g. *HQ-CDG-2027-02-15.csv*. HQ data moves through the offseason, and a stale file read with confidence is worse than no file.
- **Ask what's missing.** "Which players on my roster aren't in this file?" catches the gaps it would otherwise fill from memory.
- **Respect the subscription.** Before uploading paid content to any AI tool, check that site's terms of use, and keep it out of shared or public projects.

5 Habits during the season

- **Ask for reasoning, not verdicts.** "Should I make this trade?" gets mush. "Value both sides under my scoring and show the math" gets something you can check.

- **Make it argue against you.** “Here’s my plan. Find the holes.” That works better than hoping the push-back instruction fires on its own.
- **Mind the training cutoff.** A model’s baseball knowledge stops at its training date. Call-ups, injuries, and role changes after that are invisible unless it searches the web or you hand it the data. Ask it to search.
- **Start a fresh chat when a thread gets long or goes sideways.** The project keeps your setup, so starting over costs nothing.

6 Think like an analyst

- **Ask about the sample.** A strikeout or walk rate over about 100 plate appearances can swing a lot on noise alone. Ask how big the sample is before the AI builds a story on it.
- **Agreement isn’t confirmation.** Sources built on similar data share the same errors, so three outlets agreeing tells you less than it seems. Ask the AI where the sources actually disagree.
- **Ask for a range, not a number.** A floor and a ceiling beat a single projection, especially for prospects.

7 Cautions

- **“Never guess” reduces fabrication; it doesn’t end it.** A model can say it’s following the rule and still produce a wrong stat or a made-up citation. Spot-check any number you’re going to act on against the source. Simon Prince’s textbook *Understanding Deep Learning* makes the same point: language-model output can sound right while being only partly accurate.
- **The decision is yours.** Clean, confident output invites over-trust. The AI is a research assistant, not the GM.

Where these facts come from

- Claude plans, models, and Free vs. Pro features: claude.com/pricing
- Claude personalization settings: support.claude.com, Understanding Claude’s personalization features
- ChatGPT Plus price: help.openai.com, What is ChatGPT Plus?
- ChatGPT models by plan: chatgpt.com/pricing
- ChatGPT custom instructions and character limits: help.openai.com, ChatGPT Custom Instructions
- Gemini Gems: support.google.com, Get started with Gems in Gemini Apps
- Gemini free-tier change and Google AI Pro price: Computing, Google to restrict Gemini model access for free users (Oct 8, 2026)